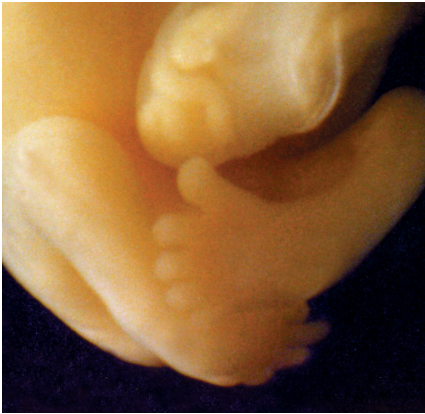




YOU ARE **9 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

212 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The lower limbs are now held flexed at the hip and knee joints, leading to a slightly crossed-legs position. The separate toes can be distinguished. Further growth of the thigh and shin bones will bring the foot length into proportion with the rest of the leg.

“ One of the downsides of pregnancy is being at greater risk of urinary tract infections, so you need to be aware of the signs. ”

Be on the lookout for any signs of a urinary tract infection. Although not very serious and easily treated, it's a complication you can do without.

An infection may cause you to urinate more frequently, but this is also a symptom of early pregnancy so it can be hard to spot. If, however, you also have stinging or discomfort when you actually urinate, lower abdominal pain, or even blood in the urine you may have developed a urinary tract infection. These infections are very common in women in general, because the urethra (tube which carries urine from the bladder to the outside) is very close to the anus and so bacteria do not have far to travel to create an infection.

In pregnancy, there are high levels of the hormone progesterone; this relaxes the tubes of the urinary system making it even easier for bacteria to enter and infect the bladder or even the kidneys. It is important to have your urine tested if you have the symptoms of a urinary-tract infection. They are usually easily treatable in pregnancy. If there is an infection, you will be prescribed antibiotics that are safe to take. The infection must be treated because, if not, it may cause a kidney infection and increase the risk of preterm labor.

STAYING IN SHAPE

If you were a regular exerciser prior to becoming pregnant, it is important to continue with some form of exercise. Stopping entirely, just because you're pregnant, would be a shock to your fit body and you may lose the benefits of the fitness you have achieved up to now.

There are some contraindications to exercising during pregnancy (see [Exercising safely](#)), but if you have clearance from your doctor, take the following steps to make sure you are exercising safely and effectively:

- **Continue with activities**, such as fast walking and swimming, as long as you feel comfortable.
- **Listen to your body**—look for signs that you should take a break, such as pain, extreme fatigue, and dizziness.